Getting Started with Zoho Creator: Account Setup and Building a Form-Based Application

Case Study 10

Aim

To set up a Zoho Creator account and build a simple form-based application for collecting and storing data.

Objective

- Understand Zoho Creator and its basic components.
- Create an account and explore the workspace.
- Create an application and design a form with different field types.
- Add records, view data and test the application.

About Zoho Creator

Zoho Creator is a low-code application development platform from Zoho Corporation. It lets users build web and mobile applications using drag-and-drop forms, reports, pages and workflows, with the Deluge scripting language for custom logic.

Basic Components

Component	Purpose
Application	A container holding all forms, reports, pages and workflows
Form	Interface to enter data; each form creates a database table
Field	An individual input element (text, number, date, dropdown, etc.)
Report	Displays the records stored by forms
Page	Custom layout with charts, text, buttons and reports
Workflow	Automated actions triggered by events (e.g., form submission)

Selected Application

Student Registration App – collects student details for a training programme and stores them for the administrator.

Procedure

A. Account Setup

1. Open the Zoho Creator website (creator.zoho.com) and click **Sign Up** / **Start Free Trial**.
2. Enter name, e-mail and password (or sign in with an existing Google / Zoho account); select the data centre / region.
3. Verify the e-mail address and complete the sign-in. The Creator home page (workspace) opens.

B. Create the Application

1. Click **Create Application** → **Create from scratch**.
2. Enter the application name “Student Registration” and click Create.

C. Build the Form

1. Choose **Create Form** and name it “Student Registration Form”.

2 Drag fields from the left panel onto the canvas and set their properties:

Field Name	Field Type	Properties
Student Name	Name / Single Line	Mandatory
Email	Email	Mandatory, unique
Phone Number	Phone / Number	Mandatory, 10 digits
Date of Birth	Date	Optional
Gender	Radio	Choices: Male, Female, Other
Course	Dropdown	Choices: Python, Web Design, Data Analytics
Address	Multi-line	Optional
Photo	Image / File upload	Optional

1 Set field rules such as “Mandatory”, “No duplicate values” and a default value where required.

2 Click **Access this application** (Live mode) to test the form.

3 Fill the form with sample data and click **Submit**; the record appears in the automatically generated report (list view).

4 Return to Edit mode and use **Share** to give access to other users or publish the form as a public link.

Observations

- Creating a form automatically generates a database table and a default list report.
- Field validations (mandatory, unique) prevented incomplete and duplicate entries.
- Edit mode is for building; Live mode is for using the application.
- The application is accessible from a browser and mobile app without extra coding.

Note: Zoho Creator's interface is updated regularly, so menu names may differ slightly between versions. Add your own screenshots of each step when submitting.

Results

- Zoho Creator account was successfully created.
- A Student Registration application with a multi-field form was built and tested.
- Records entered through the form were stored and displayed in a report.

Conclusion

Zoho Creator makes it easy to build a data-collection application in minutes without programming. Form design is the foundation of every Creator application; reports, pages and workflows are added on top of it.